

More Cool FFmpeg Tricks

These new FFmpeg tricks fill up some gaps in an article carried on this subject in *OSFY* in 2016.

This is a follow-up to the article ‘Cool FFmpeg Tricks’ (<https://www.opensourceforu.com/2016/05/cool-ffmpeg-tricks/>) I wrote for the readers of *OSFY* in 2016. Early this year, I found that the number of FFmpeg-related options in my Nautilus

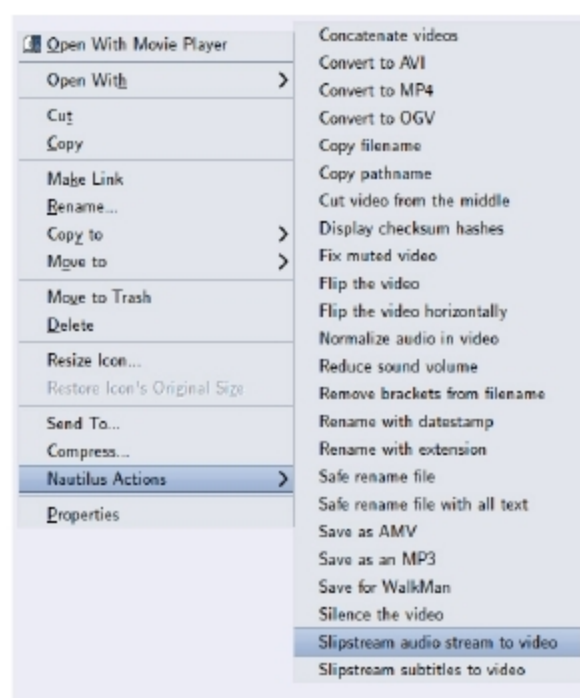


Figure 1: Use shell scripts to automate FFmpeg tasks

context menu had increased so much that there was enough material to write another FFmpeg article.

Then, I thought, why not combine the two and write a book on FFmpeg? I then started on a self-publishing spree that lasted until I had six books to my name. (My book publishing process is entirely powered by FOSS — Eclipse, Markdown/ CommonMark, KHTMLToPDF, GIMP, Inkscape, Itext, ImageMagick and Calibre. I did not spend a paisa on anything other than Internet and electricity.) You can find my books at <https://www.amazon.com/author/vsubhash>.

FFmpeg installation

FFmpeg now includes three programs — ffmpeg, ffprobe and ffplay. In 2018, ffserver was removed.

- **Build from source:** It is best if you compile the source code and build the FFmpeg programs on your OS. *FFmpeg.org* provides guides for several operating systems (<https://trac.ffmpeg.org/wiki/>

CompilationGuide/Ubuntu).

- **Download binaries:** Compiled binaries (executable files of the three programs) are available from <https://ffmpeg.zeranoe.com/builds/>.
- **Statically built binaries:** I am still on Ubuntu 10.10, and I am unable to compile the FFmpeg source code on it. However, I was able to write the book using the latest build thanks to statically built binaries from the site <https://johnvansickle.com/ffmpeg/>.

[The grubs in my Ubuntu 10.10 and Ubuntu 20 are unable to boot each other. Anyone who knows the fix can email info@vsubhash.com.]

Concatenate videos

When I wrote my original article, I was an FFmpeg newbie. Cutting and pasting together videos is not as troublefree as the article may have suggested. All input videos have to have the same codec, dimensions and frame rate. Although FFmpeg may try its best, the conversion can fail or the final video